

Grade 3 – Global Interactions

Overview

In grade 3, students will expand on their understanding of the concept of community and widen their global lens by exploring interactions between groups of people in Africa, Asia, Europe, and Oceania. Students will explain continuities and differences among cultures, governments, traditions, and resources to investigate how individuals work together while acknowledging different perspectives and cultivating empathy. Students will learn how culture spreads across borders, and students will compare and contrast Vermont/local community customs and traditions to others in the world. Students will explain current and historic patterns of human settlement and compare the ways various cultural groups connect and interact. Students will describe how resources vary across geography and climates and discuss how resources can be categorized as renewable and non-renewable.

Looking Back

In grade 2, students expanded their understanding of the concept of community by exploring past and present neighboring communities in Central America, North America, South America, and the Caribbean to explain continuities and differences among cultures, governments, traditions, and available resources.

Looking Ahead

In grade 4, students will examine change and continuity in Vermont and United States history from pre-colonial times through the Civil War.

Inquiry

Why inquiry? Using inquiry as an instructional model for the teaching of social studies allows students to authentically ask questions, search for and analyze evidence, and provide explanations and arguments to challenges facing their world.



The inquiry instructional model is driven by authentic questions or problems that have relevance for children. Students learn content, skills, and dispositions as they seek answers to questions and as they apply their learning to take informed action. Pioneered by Dewey (1938), inquiry is an attempt to make classroom experiences feel more like the authentic, curiosity-driven experiences that motivate learning outside of school. ([Using Inquiry to Prepare Students for College, Career, and Civic Life](#), elementary edition, p. 22)

The Inquiry Arc is defined in Dimension 1 (questions), Dimension 3 (evidence), and Dimension 4 (communication) of the [College, Career, and Civic Life \(C3\) Framework for Social Studies State Standards](#). In the AOE-developed Proficiency-Based Learning Social Studies Hierarchy, Dimensions 1, 2, and 3, as well as evidence indicators found within Dimension 2 – History, have been combined into a singular Critical Proficiency – the Inquiry Process. Opportunities for showing proficiency in the Inquiry Process fall within the K-2, 3-5, 6-8 grade bands of the Priority Performance Indicators (below): Constructing Compelling and Supporting Questions, Gathering and Evaluating Sources, and Communicating and Critiquing Solutions. The Inquiry Process Critical Proficiency, as with all of the CPs, begins its focus in the elementary grades and spans through high school, preparing students to attain proficiency in social studies for college and career readiness.

The Critical Proficiency (CP) remains the same K-12 and identifies the enduring skills and knowledge that all students need to demonstrate (across contexts) to be prepared for future learning, including post-secondary career and college readiness. Priority Performance Indicators clarify what will be taught and assessed at each grade cluster.

Critical Proficiency (K-12): Students act as social scientists as they ask questions, think critically, solve problems, and share conclusions.

Priority Performance Indicators (3-5):

- **Constructing Compelling and Supporting Questions:** Explain why compelling and supporting questions are important and how associated ideas can be open to different interpretations. (D1. 1-3)
- **Gathering and Evaluating Sources:** Compare information from different sources and use differences between fact and opinion to determine the credibility of the source. (D2. His. 10, 12; D3. 1-3)
- **Communicating and Critiquing Solutions:** Use evidence from multiple sources to develop a claim or argument about the past. (D2. His. 16; D4. 1)

Overarching Themes:

- Identity
- Resources
- Environmental Connections
- Relationships

Civics

Critical Proficiency (K-12): Students act as productive citizens by understanding the history, foundations, and principles of our democracy through multiple lenses, and by acquiring the ability to become engaged in civic and democratic processes.

Theme: Identity

Priority Performance Indicator (PPI)	Sample PPI Connections	Sample Content Connections
Civic and Political Institutions Explain the origins, function, key provisions and structure of the U.S. and Vermont Constitution, including the roles and responsibilities of citizens, organizations, and governments within a democratic system. (D2. Civ. 1-6)	Students will identify similarities and differences between U.S. and Vermont governments. Students will identify similarities and differences between types of governments in Africa, Asia, Europe, and Oceania. Students will be able to identify how government can look different at different times and in continents/ areas/civilizations in Africa, Asia, Europe, and Oceania.	Different Types of Governments: United States and Vermont • Democracies; both follow the three-branch system (executive, legislative, judicial), have elected officials, and written constitutions • Governor vs. President; laws- state vs. federal Africa • Example: South Africa ○ Type: Democracy (similar to U.S.) ○ Structure: President, Parliament, Constitutional Court ○ Difference: President is chosen by Parliament, not directly by voters • Example: Eritrea ○ Type: One-party authoritarian state ○ Difference: Citizens do not vote freely; limited political freedom Asia • Example: India ○ Type: Parliamentary Democracy ○ Difference: Voters elect a parliament, and parliament selects the prime minister • Example: China ○ Type: One-party Communist state ○ Difference: No free elections for national leaders; all major decisions made by the Communist Party

Priority Performance Indicator (PPI)	Sample PPI Connections	Sample Content Connections
Civic and Political Institutions (continued)	(continued)	Europe • Example: United Kingdom ○ Type: Constitutional Monarchy + Parliamentary Democracy ○ Structure: Monarch (King/Queen) + Prime Minister + Parliament ○ Difference: Monarch has ceremonial role; real power lies with elected leaders • Example: Russia ○ Type: Technically a federal republic, but functions more like an authoritarian state ○ Difference: Elections occur, but critics say power is heavily controlled by the president Oceania • Example: Australia ○ Type: Parliamentary Democracy and Constitutional Monarchy ○ Structure: Prime Minister + Parliament + ceremonial monarch (King of England) ○ Similarity: People vote for representatives; courts are independent • Example: Fiji ○ Type: Parliamentary Republic ○ Past military coups; now functions more democratically

Priority Performance Indicator (PPI)	Sample PPI Connections	Sample Content Connections
Civic and Political Institutions (continued)	(continued)	Government Examples by Region and Time Period Africa • Ancient Egypt (Old Kingdom) – Pharaoh was considered a god and ruled with total power (theocracy/monarchy). • Mali Empire (1200s–1400s) – Emperor (Mansa) ruled with help from advisors and local leaders. • Modern South Africa – Today has a democratic government with a president and parliament. • Shows a shift from monarchy and empire to democracy. Asia • Ancient China (Qin Dynasty) – Emperor had absolute power; used strict laws (legalism). • Mughal Empire (India) – Ruled by emperors with regional governors. • Modern Japan – Constitutional monarchy with elected parliament and a ceremonial emperor. • Government changed from absolute monarchy to constitutional democracy.

Priority Performance Indicator (PPI)	Sample PPI Connections	Sample Content Connections
Civic and Political Institutions (continued)	(continued)	Europe • Ancient Greece (Athens) – Early form of direct democracy. • Medieval Europe – Feudal monarchies, with kings and nobles holding power. • Modern Germany or UK – Democracies with parliaments and prime ministers. • Shift from feudal/royal rule to parliamentary and democratic governments. Oceania • Traditional Polynesian societies – Led by chiefs or elders with tribal leadership systems. • Colonial Australia – Governed by British-appointed officials. • Modern Australia & New Zealand – Parliamentary democracies with elected leaders. • Change from tribal governance to colonial rule, then to modern democracy.

Priority Performance Indicator (PPI)	Sample PPI Connections	Sample Content Connections
Civic Virtues and Democratic Principles Identify and apply core civic virtues and democratic principles that guide personal beliefs, as well as those of government, societies, and communities. (D2.Civ. 7, 8, 9, 10)	Students will identify how a nation's identity is influenced by the beliefs and values of various cultures (e.g., in Africa, Asia, Europe, and Oceania). Students will explain the factors that shape their culture and identities and acknowledge the potential for overlapping identities.	Africa Example: South Africa – Cultural Diversity and National Identity • Content Focus: The concept of the “Rainbow Nation” reflects South Africa’s diverse cultural, linguistic, and ethnic makeup. • Beliefs/Values: Ubuntu (“I am because we are”) emphasizes community and interconnectedness, shaping social and political attitudes. • National Identity: Post-apartheid South Africa’s identity centers around reconciliation, inclusivity, and multiculturalism. Asia Example: India – Religion and Pluralism • Content Focus: India’s identity is shaped by the coexistence of Hinduism, Islam, Christianity, Sikhism, Buddhism, and Jainism. • Beliefs/Values: Emphasis on religious tolerance, family structures, and respect for tradition. • National Identity: “Unity in diversity” is a foundational idea in Indian identity and politics. Europe Example: United Kingdom – Influence of Immigration and Colonial History • Content Focus: The UK’s cultural landscape has been shaped by centuries of immigration from former colonies and Europe. • Beliefs/Values: Values like democracy, individual rights, and multiculturalism contribute to national identity.

Priority Performance Indicator (PPI)	Sample PPI Connections	Sample Content Connections
Civic Virtues and Democratic Principles (continued)	(continued)	Europe (continued) • National Identity: Ongoing debates around British identity, especially in relation to Brexit and regional identities (Scottish, Welsh, etc.). Africa Example: South Africa – Cultural Diversity and National Identity • Content Focus: The concept of the “Rainbow Nation” reflects South Africa’s diverse cultural, linguistic, and ethnic makeup. • Beliefs/Values: Ubuntu (“I am because we are”) emphasizes community and interconnectedness, shaping social and political attitudes. • National Identity: Post-apartheid South Africa’s identity centers around reconciliation, inclusivity, and multiculturalism. Asia Example: India – Religion and Pluralism • Content Focus: India’s identity is shaped by the coexistence of Hinduism, Islam, Christianity, Sikhism, Buddhism, and Jainism. • Beliefs/Values: Emphasis on religious tolerance, family structures, and respect for tradition. • National Identity: “Unity in diversity” is a foundational idea in Indian identity and politics.

Priority Performance Indicator (PPI)	Sample PPI Connections	Sample Content Connections
Civic Virtues and Democratic Principles (continued)	(continued)	Europe Example: United Kingdom – Influence of Immigration and Colonial History Content Focus: The UK's cultural landscape has been shaped by centuries of immigration from former colonies and Europe. • Beliefs/Values: Values like democracy, individual rights, and multiculturalism contribute to national identity. • National Identity: Ongoing debates around British identity, especially in relation to Brexit and regional identities (Scottish, Welsh, etc.). Oceania • Example: Australia – Indigenous and Immigrant Cultures • Content Focus: The identity of modern Australia is shaped by Aboriginal traditions and beliefs alongside British colonial and more recent immigrant influences. • Beliefs/Values: Aboriginal values like connection to land (Country) and kinship influence environmental and social policy debates. • National Identity: Evolving concepts of national identity that include reconciliation with Indigenous peoples and recognition of multicultural contributions.

Priority Performance Indicator (PPI)	Sample PPI Connections	Sample Content Connections
Rules, Processes, and Laws Explain how and why people address public problems and make changes to society. (D2. Civ. 11-14)	Students will explain how individuals have brought about change in their community and nation over time in Africa, Asia, Europe, and Oceania.	Africa • Nelson Mandela (South Africa) • Led the fight against apartheid (racial segregation) • Became the first Black president of South Africa • Worked for equality and reconciliation • Wangari Maathai (Kenya) • Started the Green Belt Movement • Helped women plant millions of trees and protect the environment Asia • Mahatma Gandhi (India) • Led nonviolent protests to gain India's independence from Britain • Inspired civil rights movements worldwide • Malala Yousafzai (Pakistan) • Advocated for girls' education despite being attacked • Won the Nobel Peace Prize at age 17 Europe • Florence Nightingale (UK) • Revolutionized modern nursing and improved hospitals during war • Oskar Schindler (Germany/Poland) • Saved over 1,000 Jewish people during the Holocaust by employing them in his factories

Priority Performance Indicator (PPI)	Sample PPI Connections	Sample Content Connections
Rules, Processes, and Laws (continued)	(continued)	Oceania • Eddie Mabo (Australia) • Fought for the land rights of Indigenous Australians • Led to a major legal change in how Indigenous land ownership was recognized • Kate Sheppard (New Zealand) • Led the women's suffrage movement • Helped New Zealand become the first country to give women the right to vote (1893)

Resources

Children's Rights - C3 IDM: The third-grade annotated inquiry focuses on the concept of universal human rights and fair treatment of all people through the compelling question “Do people around the world care about children’s rights?” This question highlights the idea that human rights, including the right to have one’s basic needs met, are to be universally ensured and protected. Around the world there are many instances of human rights violations, but there are also individuals, groups, and nations who work to protect and defend human rights. The focus on *children’s* rights—the idea that children have unique rights that apply to them as nonadult members of the global citizenry—offers students an opportunity to examine the idea that they have rights and to understand that they can have an impact on the world.

Discovering My Identity - Learning for Justice: “In this lesson, students will describe aspects of their identities such as race, gender, ability, religion and more. Then after exploring Marley Dias' Black Girls Books campaign, students will analyze book illustrations and write their own book review noting how characters are similar and different from them.”

Leadership and Government - C3 IDM: “This inquiry is an exploration into governments around the world; it examines how the fundamental principles of governments vary in different world communities with diverse political systems. In

uncovering the idea that the role of citizens varies in governments around the world, students develop an argument supported by evidence that answers the compelling question ‘Does it matter how leaders are chosen?’”

[Vermont Classroom Blueprint](#) - **Vermont Office of the Secretary of State:** A K-12 ‘blueprint’ providing resources and lesson plans for active civic engagement in your classroom.

Economics

Critical Proficiency (K-12): Students make sound economic decisions through understanding the interactions between humans, governments, economic systems and both the national and global marketplaces.

Theme: Resources

Priority Performance Indicator (PPI)	Sample PPI Connections	Sample Content Connections
Economic Decision Making Identify the incentives (positive/ negative) that influence economic decisions and the benefits and costs of such decisions. (D2. Econ. 1, 2)	Students will be able to identify factors that encourage or limit how people use resources and produce goods in Africa, Asia, Europe, and Oceania.	• Encourages Production: Proximity to, and availability of, resources and technology • Limits Production: Taxation or government control, tariffs, war/conflict, cultural norms, market access • Regional Production Considerations: ○ Africa – Positive: Natural resources support exports; Negative: environmental damage ○ Asia – Positive: Access to trade routes and workforce; Negative: pollution ○ Europe – Positive: strong economies; Negative: historical overuse of natural resources (coal) ○ Oceania – Positive: Clean farming; Negative: environmental impact of farming

Priority Performance Indicator (PPI)	Sample PPI Connections	Sample Content Connections
Exchange and Markets Explain the role of business in an economic system, including resources that are needed for production, the purpose of specialization, mediums of exchange, and the value of investments. (D2. Econ. 3, 4, 5, 6, 9)	Students will be able to compare and contrast how production and consumption is the same and different across multiple civilizations in Africa, Asia, Europe, and Oceania, now and in the past.	Then vs. Now: Regional Examples Africa • Past: Ancient Ghana and Mali traded gold and salt across the Sahara. • Now: Countries like Nigeria export oil, and Ivory Coast exports cocoa. • Comparison: Then and now, Africa relies on natural resources, but modern economies are more connected to global markets. Asia • Past: Ancient China produced silk, porcelain, and tea, traded via the Silk Road. • Now: China and India produce electronics, clothing, and software for global markets. • Comparison: Asia still leads in mass production, but goods have shifted from hand-made luxury items to high-tech and industrial goods. Europe • Past: Feudal Europe focused on local farming and craft production (blacksmiths, weavers). • Now: Europe is known for automobiles, fashion, and finance (e.g., Germany, France, UK). • Comparison: Europe shifted from rural agriculture to urban, technology-based economies.

Priority Performance Indicator (PPI)	Sample PPI Connections	Sample Content Connections
Exchange and Markets (continued)	(Continued)	Oceania • Past: Indigenous groups in Australia and the Pacific produced and consumed local goods (fish, tools, woven goods) within small communities. • Now: Australia and New Zealand produce wool, dairy, minerals, and participate in global trade. • Comparison: There's a shift from self-sufficiency to globalized production, though traditional practices are still preserved in some communities.
The National Economy Explain how the economy fluctuates and how the government can affect changes through interest rates and purchase of goods and services. (D2. Econ. 10, 11, 12, 13)	Students will be able to describe elements of an economy (e.g., bartering, trade, etc.)	• Bartering – Trading goods and services without using money; still practiced in rural parts of Asia and Africa • Currency – Money used to buy goods and services; Euro, Rand, Yen, Australian dollar • Goods – Physical items produced or sold; Rice (Asia), wine (Europe), gold (South Africa), wool (Oceania) • Services – Activities people do for money; tourism, tech support • Resources – Natural materials used in production; oil, timber

Priority Performance Indicator (PPI)	Sample PPI Connections	Sample Content Connections
The Global Economy Explain how trade leads to economic interdependence and how trade can affect some groups of people. (D2. Econ. 15)	Students will be able to explain economic interactions with nearby and distant places.	Geography and Specialization Africa • Geography: Rich in minerals (gold, diamonds), oil reserves, and tropical climates. • Specialization: Mining (South Africa), oil production (Nigeria), cocoa farming (Ivory Coast). • Impact: Natural resources are key to exports, but reliance on them can make economies unstable. Asia • Geography: Large rivers (Yangtze, Ganges), fertile plains, monsoon climate, mountains. • Specialization: • India – agriculture (rice, tea). • China – manufacturing (gunpowder, textiles). • Middle East – oil and gas (Saudi Arabia, Iran). • Impact: Geography supports both farming in some areas and energy production in others. Europe • Geography: Access to rivers and seas, moderate climate, fertile land, and natural resources. • Specialization: • Germany – automobiles and machinery.

Priority Performance Indicator (PPI)	Sample PPI Connections	Sample Content Connections
The Global Economy (continued)	(continued)	Europe (continued) • France/Italy – wine and cheese (from climate and farming conditions). • Scandinavia – fishing and forestry. Impact: Physical features support high-tech industry and trade through ports. Oceania • Geography: Island geography, deserts (Australia), fertile coastlines. • Specialization: • Australia – mining (iron ore, coal), sheep farming, wheat. • New Zealand – dairy and wool. • Pacific Islands – tourism and fishing. • Impact: Remote locations can make trade harder, but natural beauty boosts tourism.

Resources

Global Trade - C3 IDM: “This inquiry leads students through an investigation of economic systems by focusing on the context of trade among world communities. Trading is one of the oldest forms of economic interaction among humans, yet it is also among the most complex. In examining the reasons for international trade and the exports of world communities, students should be able to develop an argument supported by evidence to answer the compelling question: ‘Why do countries need each other?’”

Globalization - C3 IDM: This inquiry engages third graders in expanding their understandings of our increasingly interconnected world. The compelling question “Is sharing and trading across cultures always a good thing?” is intellectually respectful of third graders who have personal experience with sharing and trading and typically have been told that sharing and trading are positive ways to interact. This inquiry explores that assumption in ways that allow

students to engage with several social studies disciplines as students uncover political, economic, and social connections across cultures and analyze the implications of those connections.

Understanding Economics - Core Knowledge: This 5-lesson unit “*Understanding Economics*” will provide an overview of the following content: Every society must answer basic economic questions: What will the society produce? How will society produce it? How will society distribute it? The answers to these questions are shaped by many factors, including access to resources, access to technology, and cultural values. Similarly, individuals also make economic decisions about what to buy, where to buy it, when to save, how much to save, and so on. These decisions are informed by the availability of goods and services, prices, and personal values.

Where in the World... Does All This Stuff Come From? - National Council for Social Studies: With labels removed from products, students identify on a world map where products are made around the world. This Inquiry was geared to middle school students but can easily be scaled down for elementary classrooms.

Geography

Critical Proficiency (K-12): Students use geographic inquiry and reasoning to propose solutions to local, national, and global issues.

Theme: Environmental Connections

Priority Performance Indicator (PPI)	Sample PPI Connections	Sample Content Connections
Geographic Representations: Spatial Views of the World Create and/or use maps with different scales of familiar and unfamiliar places, to explain relationships of places to their environment including cultural and environmental characteristics. (D2. Geo. 1, 2, 3)	Students will be able to explain cultural and environmental characteristics that unify regions in Africa, Asia, Europe, and Oceania. Students will locate and name important countries, cities, landmarks, and physical features in Africa, Asia, Europe, and Oceania on a world map.	Types of Characteristics That Can Unify a Region 1. Cultural – shared religion, language, customs, or history 2. Physical/Geographic – similar climate, landforms, or location 3. Political – similar governments, alliances, or borders 4. Economic – shared trade, industries, or resources Key Locations by Region Africa • Countries: Egypt, Nigeria, South Africa, Kenya, Ghana • Cities: Cairo, Lagos, Johannesburg, Nairobi • Landforms: Sahara Desert, Nile River, Mount Kilimanjaro, Congo River Asia • Countries: China, India, Japan, Russia, Saudi Arabia • Cities: Beijing, New Delhi, Tokyo, Mecca, Bangkok • Landforms: Himalayas, Ganges River, Yangtze River, Arabian Desert Europe • Countries: United Kingdom, France, Germany, Italy, Spain • Cities: London, Paris, Rome, Berlin, Madrid • Landforms: Alps Mountains, Danube River, Mediterranean Sea

Priority Performance Indicator (PPI)	Sample PPI Connections	Sample Content Connections
Human-Environment Interaction: Place, Regions, and Culture Explain the relationship between culture and environment and how both can change over time. (D2. Geo. 4, 5, 6)	Students will be able to explain how geography and the environment have impacted culture over time in Africa, Asia, Europe, and Oceania.	Oceania • Countries: Australia, New Zealand, Papua New Guinea, Fiji • Cities: Sydney, Wellington, Port Moresby Landforms: Great Barrier Reef, Outback, Southern Alps (New Zealand) Key Concepts: • Climate, landforms, natural resources, isolation vs. access Impacts on Culture: • Clothing, housing, economy, transportation, food, religion (spiritual ties to land)

Priority Performance Indicator (PPI)	Sample PPI Connections	Sample Content Connections
Human Population: Spatial Patterns and Movements Explain how population shifts affect both culture and environment, and how a changing environment can affect human settlement patterns. (D2. Geo. 7, 8, 9)	Students will be able to identify changing environments in Africa, Europe, Asia, and Oceania and how those changes have impacted human settlement. Students will explain how diverse cultural attributes spread to new places.	Movement of language, food, religion and traditions - Colonization – Indian traditions found in East African countries like Kenya and Tanzania Urban growth, deforestation, pollution - Rapid urbanization in China has led to air and water pollution due to industrial development. Changing Environments Affect Human Settlements: - Environmental changes like droughts, floods, and rising sea levels can cause people to move. - Desertification in the Sahel region of Africa pushes people to leave rural areas and move to cities or other countries. Geography and the Environment Africa Geography: Sahara Desert, Nile River, savannas, tropical rainforests Cultural Impact: - The Nile River allowed for farming and led to the rise of powerful civilizations like Ancient Egypt. - The Sahara limited movement but also helped create trans-Saharan trade routes—leading to the spread of Islam and the rise of empires like Mali. - Diverse environments led to many ethnic groups and languages each adapted to local climates.

Priority Performance Indicator (PPI)	Sample PPI Connections	Sample Content Connections
Human Population: Spatial Patterns and Movements (continued)	(continued)	Asia • Geography: Himalayas, Gobi Desert, monsoons, rivers (Yangtze, Ganges) • Cultural Impact: ○ Monsoons shaped farming and religious practices (e.g., in India, monsoon rains are linked to spiritual beliefs about nature). ○ Mountain ranges isolated areas, allowing unique cultures like Tibet or Japan to develop. Europe • Geography: Mountains (Alps, Pyrenees), rivers (Danube, Rhine), Mediterranean Sea, temperate climate • Cultural Impact: • The Mediterranean Sea allowed for trade and cultural exchange among Greeks, Romans, and others—spreading art, architecture, and religion. • Mild climate helped support agriculture, leading to population growth and early urbanization. • Natural barriers like the Alps influenced the development of different languages and political boundaries. Oceania (Australia, New Zealand, and Pacific Islands) • Geography: Isolated islands, ocean-dependent cultures, coral reefs, deserts (Australia)

Priority Performance Indicator (PPI)	Sample PPI Connections	Sample Content Connections
Human Population: Spatial Patterns and Movements (continued)	(continued)	• Cultural Impact: ○ Pacific Islanders became expert navigators, using stars and waves to explore vast ocean distances—forming a rich tradition of oral history and storytelling. ○ Aboriginal Australians developed deep spiritual connections to land features ("Dreamtime" stories tied to the landscape). ○ Isolation led to unique ecosystems and cultural traditions not found anywhere else in the world.

Priority Performance Indicator (PPI)	Sample PPI Connections	Sample Content Connections
Global Interconnections: Changing Spatial Patterns Describe how spatial patterns can be transformed through natural and man-made disturbances, and how patterns vary across the world and can change over time. (D2. Geo. 10, 11, 12)	Students will be able to explain that people across Africa, Asia, Europe, and Oceania have adapted to and modified their environment in different ways to meet their needs. Students will be able to explain how different groups interact with the environment in both positive and negative ways in Africa, Asia, Europe, and Oceania.	Adaptations and Modifications Africa • Adaptation: Nomadic herders in the Sahel move seasonally to find grazing land for animals. • Modification: Building irrigation systems along the Nile River to grow crops in dry areas. Asia • Adaptation: People in mountainous areas like the Himalayas build homes on slopes and use terraced farming. • Modification: In Japan, people build earthquake-resistant buildings to stay safe in natural disasters. Europe • Adaptation: In colder regions like Scandinavia, people wear heavy clothing, build insulated homes, and rely on indoor heating. • Modification: The Dutch built dikes and canals to control flooding and reclaim land from the sea in the Netherlands. Oceania • Adaptation: Indigenous groups in Australia adapted to desert life by learning to find water and hunt with traditional tools. • Modification: People in New Zealand cleared forests for sheep farming and built cities in coastal areas.

Priority Performance Indicator (PPI)	Sample PPI Connections	Sample Content Connections
Global Interconnections: Changing Spatial Patterns (continued)	(continue)	Positive and Negative Impacts Africa • Example: Building dams on the Nile River (like the Aswan High Dam) • Positive View: Helps control floods, creates electricity, improves farming. • Negative View: Disrupts natural flow, affects fish and farmland downstream, and floods ancient sites. • Example: Rainforest clearing in Central Africa • Positive View: Creates farmland and jobs. • Negative View: Destroys ecosystems, affects global climate, and displaces Indigenous peoples. Asia • Example: Rice farming in Southeast Asia using terrace systems • Positive View: Efficient use of land, supports large populations, sustainable over time. • Negative View: Can lead to soil erosion and water use issues if mismanaged. • Example: Urban development in China and India • Positive View: Economic growth, new infrastructure, housing. • Negative View: Air and water pollution, loss of green spaces, displacement of rural communities. Europe • Example: Industrial Revolution (18th–19th centuries) • Positive View: Innovation, jobs, and economic growth.

Priority Performance Indicator (PPI)	Sample PPI Connections	Sample Content Connections
Global Interconnections: Changing Spatial Patterns (continued)	(continued)	Europe (continued) • Negative View: Air and water pollution, overuse of coal, environmental damage. • Example: Wind farms in Northern Europe • Positive View: Clean energy, reduced carbon emissions. • Negative View: Some people believe they spoil landscapes or affect bird populations. Oceania • Example: Mining in Australia • Positive View: Boosts economy, provides jobs and resources. • Negative View: Harms sacred Aboriginal lands, pollutes rivers, damages ecosystems. • Example: Traditional fishing by Pacific Islander communities • Positive View: Sustainable, culturally important, respects marine life. • Negative View: Overfishing by foreign companies now threatens their way of life.

Resources

[Building the Pyramids of Ancient Egypt](#) - **PBS Learning Media:** In this interactive lesson supporting literacy skills, students learn how historians think the pyramids were built and why they were built—as doorways to the afterlife for the pharaohs. Students develop their literacy skills as they explore a social studies focus on ancient Egyptian society and how those at the top organized the rest of the population in order to build these amazing structures. During this process, they read informational text, learn and practice vocabulary words, and explore content through videos and interactive activities.

Confucius: A Life - **PBS Learning Media:** Students will read a short history of Confucius. They will explore some principle elements of Confucius's teachings. Finally, they will read three quotes from The Analects and correctly identify the Confucian principles they show. Teacher notes are included.

Cultural Diversity - **C3 IDM:** This inquiry engages third graders in expanding their understandings of diverse cultures. The compelling question, "How does our culture make us similar and different?" is intellectually respectful of students who, by their nature, are interested in people and their similarities and differences. It allows for engagement with several social studies disciplines as students examine diverse cultures and histories around the globe.

Examining Changes to the Environment Through Pictures and Data - **Statistics in Schools:** Students will examine how human actions and population changes can affect the environment. Students will examine a series of photographs that compare famous landmarks (Times Square, the Saltair Pavilion in Utah, Laguna Beach, and Niagara Falls) across time, and then they will identify human-generated changes in the physical environment, such as the addition of bridges and roads. Students will also examine U.S. Census Bureau population and housing data to see how population changes can contribute to changes in the physical environment. In addition, students will describe the impact of these changes on the environment. (Suggested grades 4-6)

5-Minute Challenge: Center of Population Story Map Scavenger Hunt - **Statistics in Schools:** What is the center of population and how has the evolution of infrastructure and technology influenced population movement throughout the decades? For this activity, students use a story map, an interactive web tool with maps, text, and photos to learn about the nation's centers of population and test their knowledge about their findings.

Fun with Geography - **National Geographic:** Get ideas for how to have fun with geography in your daily life. Lessons include "Draw a Map of an Imaginary Island," "Learn About Seasonal Celebrations," and "Explore a Line of Latitude."

Geography - **C3 IDM:** This inquiry engages third-grade students in exploring world geography through the compelling question, "Where are we?" This question sparks students' intellectual curiosity through the study of geographic location and the impact of humans on their environment. Working with evidence from sources, students should understand that, although we can be in different 'places, our impact on Earth is worth considering.

Interactive Human Migration Map - **PBS Learning Media:** Using archeological, genetic, and climate data, scientists have pieced together an outline of the human odyssey—the journey that took our species from Africa to all corners of the globe. Experience this 200,000-year migration using an interactive human migration map.

MapMaker: Cities of the World - National Geographic: This Interactive map is for grades 5+ but can be teacher-led as a whole class visual exercise.

Remote Sensing Classroom - Earth Resources Observation and Science Center - USGS: Fun and engaging educational lessons allow students to look at satellite imagery and perform the same analysis as the remote sensing scientists at EROS. Students of all ages can learn how remote sensing scientists use Landsat satellite data to track changes to the Earth's surface over the years. There's games and puzzles to test student skills. "[Tracking Changes to the Earth's Surface](#)" and "[Land Change with Landstat](#)" are two of the many interactive geography opportunities.

Where is Gina the Geographer? Statistics in Schools: Students will participate in an online scavenger hunt based on a story that a geographer named Gina, who loves to travel, has escaped to an undisclosed location. It is their mission to bring her back to the school. Students must follow a series of clues about the location including landmarks, weather, and population—and use a U.S. Census Bureau data tool called State Facts for Students to answer questions that lead them one step closer to finding Gina. (Suggested grades 4-5)

World Mountains - Core Knowledge: In this 4-lesson unit, students review their skills of using maps and globes and then apply those skills in learning about major mountains and mountain ranges. They explore the Himalayas and Urals in Asia; the Atlas Mountains in Africa; the Andes in South America; the Appalachians and Rockies in North America; and the Alps and Caucasus in Europe. Students also study the tallest mountains on each continent.

World Rivers - Core Knowledge: This 7-lesson unit prepares students to use maps and globes to locate the continents, major oceans, and important world rivers. Students explore the benefits and dangers of rivers. They learn why ancient civilizations and modern cities were established near rivers, and how rivers are often associated with major historical events. Rivers studied include the Ganges, Indus, Yellow (Huang He), Yangtze (Chang Jiang), Tigris, Euphrates, Nile, Niger, Congo, Amazon, Orinoco, Mississippi, Mackenzie, Yukon, Murray, Darling, Volga, Danube, and Rhine.

History

Critical Proficiency (K-12): Students understand and evaluate change and continuity over time, recognize the multiplicity of points of view and make appropriate use of historical evidence in answering questions and developing arguments about the past.

Theme: Relationships

Priority Performance Indicator (PPI)	Sample PPI Connections	Sample Content Connections
Change, Continuity, and Context Create a chronological sequence to compare and contrast developments within a similar time period, with a focus on analyzing specific individuals or groups who shaped significant changes. (D2. His. 1, 3)	Students will be able to develop a chronological sequence of events and explain significant changes in Africa, Asia, Europe, and Oceania.	Ancient Civilizations (Before 500 CE) • Africa: Rise of Ancient Egypt and Nubia • Change: Development of centralized governments, writing (hieroglyphs), and religious systems. • Asia: Maurya and Gupta Empires in India; Han Dynasty in China • Change: Spread of Buddhism; advances in science, art, and infrastructure. • Europe: Roman Empire • Change: Legal systems, engineering, and spread of Christianity. • Oceania: Indigenous societies (e.g., Aboriginal Australians, Māori) • Change: Development of oral traditions, navigation, and land-based spirituality. Medieval Era (500–1500 CE) • Africa: Mali Empire (Timbuktu as a learning center) • Change: Growth of Islamic scholarship, trade networks (gold/salt) • Asia: Tang and Song Dynasties in China; Islamic Caliphates • Change: Technological innovation (printing, gunpowder), cultural flourishing • Europe: Feudal system and the Crusades • Change: Rise of monarchies, tension between religious and political power • Oceania: Continued development of tribal societies • Change: Polynesian migration and settlement of remote islands

Priority Performance Indicator (PPI)	Sample PPI Connections	Sample Content Connections
Change, Continuity, and Context (continued)	(continued)	Early Modern Period (1500–1800 CE) • Africa: Transatlantic slave trade • Change: Population displacement, disruption of kingdoms • Asia: Mughal Empire in India; Ming Dynasty in China • Change: Cultural and architectural achievements, increased European contact Europe: Age of Exploration, Scientific Revolution • Change: Colonization, global trade, rise of modern science • Oceania: First European contact (e.g., Captain Cook) • Change: Introduction of new diseases, early colonization efforts

Priority Performance Indicator (PPI)	Sample PPI Connections	Sample Content Connections
Perspectives Explain why individuals and groups during the same historical period had similar and /or different perspectives, and how those perspectives shaped the sources they influenced. (D2. His. 4-6)	Students will be able to explain cultural attributes that can lead people to have different viewpoints. Students will be able to identify, affirm, respect, and explain the diverse cultures of their community and communities in Africa, Asia, Europe, and Oceania.	Cultural Attributes • Africa – Strong community and family ties; oral traditions; deep connection to land and ancestors • Asia – Influence of religions like Buddhism, Hinduism, Islam, and Confucianism; respect for elders and social harmony • Europe – Long history of individual rights, secularism, and democratic institutions • Oceania – Strong spiritual connection to nature (e.g., the Māori concept of whakapapa – ancestral connection to land); importance of tribal and kinship networks

Priority Performance Indicator (PPI)	Sample PPI Connections	Sample Content Connections
Causation and Argumentation Explain probable causes and effects of events and developments. (D2, His. 14)	Students will be able to explain the causes and effects of major events in Africa, Asia, Europe, and Oceania. Students will be able to develop questions about a source to understand how it can be used to study the past. Students will be able to identify whose voices and perspectives are represented in the sources and whose are absent when developing an argument.	Trade Networks and Cultural Exchange • Cause: Development of major trade routes (e.g., the Silk Road, Trans-Saharan trade, Indian Ocean trade). • Interaction: Merchants, scholars, and travelers from Asia, Africa, and Europe interacted through trade and religious pilgrimage. • Effects: • Spread of religions like Islam, Christianity, and Buddhism. • Exchange of goods (e.g., spices from Asia, gold and salt from Africa, textiles from Europe). • Growth of cities like Timbuktu, Malacca, and Venice as commercial hubs. • Advancements in science, navigation, and mathematics through knowledge-sharing. Colonialism and Imperial Expansion • Cause: European powers' desire for resources, markets, and strategic control during the Age of Exploration and Industrial Revolution. • Interaction: Europe colonized large parts of Africa, Asia, and Oceania (e.g., Britain in India and Australia; France in West Africa). • Effects: • Disruption of local economies and traditional systems. • Introduction of European languages, legal systems, and education. • Resistance movements and eventual independence movements (e.g., India's independence in 1947, Ghana in 1957). • Lasting economic and political inequalities.

Priority Performance Indicator (PPI)	Sample PPI Connections	Sample Content Connections
Causation and Argumentation (continued)	(Continued)	Migration and Labor Movements (continued) • Cause: Economic opportunities, forced labor (slavery), indentured servitude, and war. • Interaction: ○ Africans forcibly taken to the Americas and Caribbean through the Atlantic slave trade. ○ Indians and Chinese migrated as indentured laborers to colonies in Africa, Oceania, and the Caribbean. • Effects: ○ Cultural blending (e.g., Indo-Fijians, Afro-Caribbeans in Europe). ○ Racial and ethnic tensions but also enriched cultural landscapes. ○ Formation of global labor systems and economic dependency Environmental and Cultural Impacts • Cause: European colonization and industrialization, followed by global economic integration. • Interaction: • Introduction of new crops and animals (e.g., maize to Africa, sheep to Oceania). • Exploitation of natural resources for global markets. • Effects: • Environmental degradation in colonized regions. • Shifts in dietary habits, agriculture, and traditional ways of life. • Revival movements aimed at preserving indigenous cultures (e.g., Maori language revitalization in New Zealand).

Resources

[AIA Lesson Plans](#) - Archaeological Institute of America: This page provides links to four lesson plans for elementary appropriate simulated digs: a [layer cake dig](#) (K-2), a [transparent shoebox dig](#) (K-2), a [shoebox dig](#) (grades 3-5), and a [schoolyard dig](#) (grades 3-5). The page also includes photographs, record sheets, and a list of resources and national standards addressed in these activities; artifacts are used by archaeologists to make inferences about past civilizations and cultures.

[Ancient India](#) - Core Knowledge: This 6-lesson unit introduces students to the early Asian civilization of ancient India. Students will explore the geography of India, the Ganges and Indus Rivers, and the development of the first civilization in the Indus valley, where present-day western India, Pakistan, and northeastern Afghanistan are located. The importance of settling near a river to be able to farm near a relatively reliable source of water is also reinforced. In the unit's six chapters, students will study the culture and beliefs associated with ancient India. They will learn about the Aryan invaders, who came to the Indus valley from other parts of Asia, and whose beliefs became interwoven with those of the Indus people, resulting in the development of a new religion called Hinduism. Students will investigate three important Hindu deities, Brahma, Vishnu, and Shiva; the most important Hindu holy books, the Vedas; the castes, or different social levels, that Hindus have divided themselves into; and Diwali, the Hindu festival of lights. Students will also explore Buddhism, which began in this region as well. They will learn about the Buddha, what he taught, and how Buddhism spread to other lands. They will study one of the Buddha's Jataka tales and how such stories helped him spread his teachings, and they will also examine the life of King Asoka, the ancient king who put Buddha's teachings into practice.

[The Vikings](#) - Core Knowledge: This 8-lesson unit begins by providing geographical information on Scandinavia, homeland of the Vikings, meaning 'pirates' in the early Scandinavian languages—a name they were given because of their brutal raids on many places in Europe. Their expertise as sailors and shipbuilders—and their fierce raiding spirit—enabled them to trade, conquer, and explore over a vast area. Students learn about the voyages of Eric the Red and his son, Leif Eriksson. Students are introduced to Norse mythology, including stories of Odin, Thor, and Loki.